

CULTURAL HERITAGE OF INDIA

Art · Architecture · Craft · Tribes · Festivals · Living Tradition

A State-Wise Heritage Dossier — Smart India Hackathon

How to use this document

Each state opens with a short narrative, a marked photo space, an at-a-glance fact panel, and a direct source link for the photo. Save an image from the linked page (or your own research) into each photo space before presenting.



Himachal Pradesh

Land of the Gods in the Western Himalayas

Himachal Pradesh's art form is Pahari miniature painting, and its famous temple is the Hadimba Temple. Its craft traditions are Kullu shawls and Chamba embroidery, carried forward alongside the old Devta traditions. The state celebrates Kullu Dussehra as its major festival, and its notable monument is Kangra Fort. Its major tribes are the Gaddi and Kinnaura, and its folk dance is the Nati. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved through Tibetan and Himalayan manuscripts.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Pahari miniature painting



Famous Temple

Hadimba Temple



Craft

Kullu shawls, Chamba embroidery



Old Tradition / Practice

Devta traditions



Festival

Kullu Dussehra



Monument / Heritage

Kangra Fort



Major Tribes

Gaddi, Kinnaura



Folk Dance

Nati



Ancient History / Knowledge

Tibetan & Himalayan manuscripts

Jharkhand

The Tribal Heartland of Eastern India

Jharkhand's art form is Sohrai and Khovar painting, and its famous temple is the Baidyanath Temple. Its craft tradition is Dokra metal craft, rooted in the old practice of Sarna nature worship. The state celebrates Sarhul as its major festival, and its notable heritage site is the cluster of Maluti Temples. Its major tribes are the Santhal, Munda and Oraon, and its folk dances are Chhau and Paika. Its ancient history and knowledge live on through tribal oral history and traditions.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Sohrai & Khovar painting



Famous Temple

Baidyanath Temple



Craft

Dokra metal craft



Old Tradition / Practice

Sarna nature worship



Festival

Sarhul



Monument / Heritage

Maluti Temples



Major Tribes

Santhal, Munda, Oraon



Folk Dance

Chhau, Paika



Ancient History / Knowledge

Tribal oral history and traditions



Karnataka

Where Empires Left Their Mark in Stone

Karnataka's art form is Mysore painting, and its famous temple is the Virupaksha Temple. Its craft traditions are Mysore silk and sandalwood carving, connected to the old Yakshagana tradition. The state celebrates Mysuru Dasara as its major festival, and its notable heritage site is Hampi. Its major tribes are the Soliga and Koraga, and its folk dance is Dollu Kunita. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved in Hampi's inscriptions and in ancient Kannada literature.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Mysore painting



Famous Temple

Virupaksha Temple



Craft

Mysore silk, sandalwood carving



Old Tradition / Practice

Yakshagana tradition



Festival

Mysuru Dasara



Monument / Heritage

Hampi



Major Tribes

Soliga, Koraga



Folk Dance

Dollu Kunita



Ancient History / Knowledge

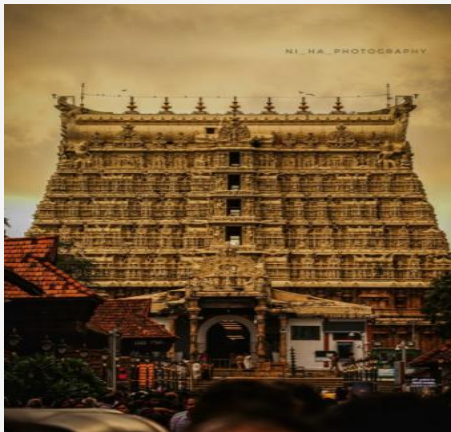
Hampi inscriptions & ancient Kannada literature



Kerala

God's Own Country of Ritual, Art and Water

Kerala's art forms are mural painting and Kathakali art, and its famous temple is the Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple. Its craft traditions are coir-making and Kasavu weaving, connected to the old Theyyam rituals. The state celebrates Onam and Thrissur Pooram as its major festivals, and its notable monument is Bekal Fort. Its major tribes are the Paniya and Kurichiya, and its folk dances are Theyyam and Mohiniyattam. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved in palm-leaf manuscripts and ancient Malayalam texts.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Mural painting, Kathakali



Famous Temple

Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple



Craft

Coir, Kasavu weaving



Old Tradition / Practice

Theyyam rituals



Festival

Onam, Thrissur Pooram



Monument / Heritage

Bekal Fort



Major Tribes

Paniya, Kurichiya



Folk Dance

Theyyam, Mohiniyattam



Ancient History / Knowledge

Palm-leaf manuscripts, Malayalam texts



Madhya Pradesh

The Heart of India, Layered in Deep Time

Madhya Pradesh's art form is Gond painting, and its famous temple site is the Khajuraho Temples. Its craft traditions are Chanderi weaving and other tribal crafts, connected to the old Bhagoria tradition. The state celebrates the Bhagoria Festival as its major festival, and its notable heritage sites are the Sanchi Stupa and Bhimbetka. Its major tribes are the Gond, Bhil and Baiga, and its folk dances are Rai and Matki. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved through rock paintings and ancient Buddhist history.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Gond painting



Famous Temple

Khajuraho Temples



Craft

Chanderi weaving, tribal crafts



Old Tradition / Practice

Bhagoria tradition



Festival

Bhagoria Festival



Monument / Heritage

Sanchi Stupa, Bhimbetka



Major Tribes

Gond, Bhil, Baiga



Folk Dance

Rai, Matki



Ancient History / Knowledge

Rock paintings, Buddhist history



Maharashtra

From Cave Carvings to Coastal Forts

Maharashtra's art form is Warli painting, and its famous temple is the Trimbakeshwar Temple. Its craft traditions are Paithani silk and Kolhapuri crafts, connected to the old Warkari pilgrimage. The state celebrates Ganesh Chaturthi as its major festival, and its notable heritage sites are the Ajanta and Ellora Caves. Its major tribes are the Warli, Bhil and Gond, and its folk dances are Lavani and Koli dance. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved in Ajanta's manuscripts and Maratha historical records.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Warli painting



Famous Temple

Trimbakeshwar Temple



Craft

Paithani silk, Kolhapuri crafts



Old Tradition / Practice

Warkari pilgrimage



Festival

Ganesh Chaturthi



Monument / Heritage

Ajanta & Ellora Caves



Major Tribes

Warli, Bhil, Gond



Folk Dance

Lavani, Koli dance



Ancient History / Knowledge

Ajanta manuscripts, Maratha records



Manipur

The Jewelled Land of the East

Manipur's art form is Manipuri traditional art, and its famous temple is the Shree Govindajee Temple. Its craft traditions are Kauna craft and handloom weaving, connected to the old Lai Haraoba rituals. The state celebrates Yaoshang and Lai Haraoba as its major festivals, and its notable monument is Kangla Fort. Its major tribes are the Tangkhul, Kuki and Hmar, and its folk dance is the Manipuri Ras Leela. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved in the Meitei manuscripts known as the Puya.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Manipuri traditional art



Famous Temple

Shree Govindajee Temple



Craft

Kauna craft, handloom



Old Tradition / Practice

Lai Haraoba rituals



Festival

Yaoshang, Lai Haraoba



Monument / Heritage

Kangla Fort



Major Tribes

Tangkhul, Kuki, Hmar



Folk Dance

Manipuri Ras Leela



Ancient History / Knowledge

Meitei manuscripts (Puya)



Meghalaya

The Abode of Clouds and Living Architecture

Meghalaya's art form is traditional bamboo art, and its famous temple is the Nartiang Durga Temple. Its craft tradition is bamboo and cane craft, connected to the old living root bridge traditions. The state celebrates Wangala and Nongkrem as its major festivals, and its notable heritage site is the Nartiang Monoliths. Its major tribes are the Khasi, Garo and Jaintia, and its folk dance is the Wangala Dance. Its ancient history and knowledge are preserved through oral traditions and Khasi and Garo folklore.



AT A GLANCE



Art Form

Traditional bamboo art



Famous Temple

Nartiang Durga Temple



Craft

Bamboo & cane craft



Old Tradition / Practice

Living root bridge traditions



Festival

Wangala, Nongkrem



Monument / Heritage

Nartiang Monoliths



Major Tribes

Khasi, Garo, Jaintia



Folk Dance

Wangala Dance



Ancient History / Knowledge

Khasi & Garo oral folklore